Presentation Script: The History of SQL (V2)

Slide 1: Title Slide

Hi everyone. Today I'm going to tell you the story of SQL. It stands for Structured Query Language, and even though it's 50 years old, it is still the language that runs almost every app and website we use today.

Slide 2: The Foundation (1970)

It all started in 1970 with this man, Dr. Edgar Codd. At the time, databases were a mess—they were like giant, confusing webs. Codd had a simple idea: why not organize data into tables, like a spreadsheet? This was called the 'Relational Model,' and it changed everything.

Slide 3: The Implementation (IBM System R)

A few years later, two other researchers at IBM—Donald Chamberlin and Raymond Boyce—created a way to actually talk to these tables. They wanted a language that sounded like plain English so that regular people, not just math experts, could use it to find information.

Slide 4: From SEQUEL to SQL

Fun fact: SQL wasn't the original name. It was first called SEQUEL (Structured English Query Language). However, an airplane company in the UK already owned that name. To avoid a legal battle, they shortened it to SQL. This is why most people today still pronounce it like the word 'Sequel' instead of saying the letters S-Q-L.

Slide 4: Becoming the Global Standard

By the late 70s and 80s, SQL exploded. Oracle released the first version for businesses. In 1986, it became the 'official' standard. This meant that no matter what brand of computer or software you used, the language for data was finally the same everywhere.

Slide 6: The Evolution of Syntax

SQL didn't stay stuck in the 80s. As technology changed, SQL grew. In the late 90s, it added complex triggers. In 2016, it learned how to handle web data like JSON. Just last year, in 2023, it was updated again to handle even more complex modern data relationships. It is constantly evolving.

Slide 7: Why It Works: Declarative Nature

The secret to SQL’s success is that it is 'Declarative.' This is a fancy way of saying you tell the database what you want, not how to get it. It’s like ordering a pizza: you tell the shop you want a Pepperoni pizza; you don't have to go into the kitchen and tell them how to knead the dough or set the oven temperature.

Slide 8: Adapting to Big Data

People once thought SQL would die when 'Big Data' and 'The Cloud' arrived, but the opposite happened. Modern giants like Google, Amazon, and Snowflake all use SQL to manage massive amounts of information. It adapted perfectly to the 21st century.

Slide 9: Thank You

In conclusion, SQL is the ultimate survivor of the tech world. It’s simple, powerful, and isn't going anywhere. Thank you for listening! Does anyone have any questions?